# Lab 5: Peer Review Workshop

*Specific feedback on a draft, and a plan for revising it*

FALL 2026 · WEEK 07 — WEEK OF MONDAY 2026-10-05, IN SECTION

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DELIVERABLES — DUE AT THE END OF YOUR LAB SECTION, ON BRIGHTSPACE

- ☐ `Lab-5_FIRSTNAME_LASTNAME.Rmd/Lab-5_FIRSTNAME_LASTNAME.qmd`: the starter sheet, renamed, with your feedback, reflection, revision plan, and generative AI disclosure completed as far as you got
- ☐ `Lab-5_FIRSTNAME_LASTNAME.pdf`: the same sheet, knitted to PDF

Report 1 is due on Sunday 2026-10-11 at 11:59 pm. Labs 2 to 4 have worked through its dataset, research question, figures, interpretations and Discussion. This lab gives you time to show your draft to classmates and hear how well they can follow the argument and where they need more explanation. It has three parts: first, discuss how you prefer to receive feedback; second, review each other's drafts; third, decide what to revise and start making those changes.

### *What to download and bring*

Please download this handout alongside `lab-05-peer-review-workshop.Rmd` or `lab-05-peer-review-workshop.qmd` from Brightspace. Save the starter in a folder for this lab (`labs/lab-05/`, for instance), rename it `Lab-5_FIRSTNAME_LASTNAME.Rmd/Lab-5_FIRSTNAME_LASTNAME.qmd`, and put your name in its header. The sheet records the conversation in words and needs no data file. If you add a figure or code that reads data from a file, please submit that file as well, as in the earlier labs.

Please have your Report 1 draft open, together with its `.Rmd` and data, and the Report 1 brief and student rubric from Brightspace. Bring the draft in its current state. If the report has not yet been assembled, use your dataset card, question and figures from Labs 2 to 4. You do not need slides or a prepared presentation. A question and one figure are enough to start a conversation about what to do next.

### *What to hand in and when*

Please knit your sheet and submit its `.Rmd/.qmd` and PDF to the Lab 5 folder on Brightspace before you leave. Each person submits their own record of the feedback they gave and received. The revised report goes into the separate Analysis Report 1 submission by its deadline.

> **NOTE — How this lab is graded**
> The syllabus's lab rubric applies: one point for arriving before the section starts, three for progress (at least half the sheet by the end), and one for the TA checking your progress when you hand it in. For this sheet, half means Part 1 and a Part 2 record of feedback you gave to at least one classmate and feedback you received on your own draft. Please continue through the other reviews and Part 3 as time allows. The quality of your draft is not a lab mark, and the comments you give do not assign a report grade. The separate peer-marking round for Report 1 is in Lab 7.

If you miss your section, please ask your TA promptly to arrange an exchange with a classmate. Complete all three parts within one week of your original lab time for the three progress points. For a TA-arranged pair, one peer-review block is enough. Please record the actual exchange. The Report 1 deadline remains 2026-10-11.

> **NOTE — Your own feedback**
> The syllabus ***does not*** allow generative AI for peer review. Please read the drafts and write the feedback yourself. The existing policy for work on your own report still applies, including disclosure of any generative AI use. The disclosure at the end of this sheet asks about work on this lab; it does not replace the disclosure in your report.

> **HINT — If knitting to PDF will not work**
> The syllabus's fallback applies: knit to HTML, convert the HTML to a PDF using your web browser or with an online converter such as `https://www.sejda.com/html-to-pdf`, and submit that PDF with the `.Rmd`/`.qmd`. Please also tell your TA.

The two-hour section leaves an hour for the reviews. Please divide that hour equally so that everyone has a turn.

| Activity | Minutes |
|---|---|
| Read the handout and see an example of feedback | 10 |
| Part 1: feedback preferences | 15 |
| Part 2: review the drafts | 60 |
| Part 3: personal and group reflection | 20 |
| Begin a revision | 10 |
| Knit, show your TA, and submit | 5 |

# Part 1: Feedback preferences

A useful comment identifies something in the report and explains its effect on the reader. A suggestion also gives the author something specific to try. For example, the following comments refer to an imaginary draft:

**WARNING — Too general to act on**

"Your figures look good."
"I think you should improve the Discussion."

**HINT — Specific feedback**

"Figure 2 uses the same scale in each panel, so I can compare the groups directly. Please keep that when you revise it."
"The Discussion lists the three figures' results separately. Could you start with a sentence that answers the research question, using what all three show?"

For each draft, please give two stars and a wish: two specific things that work, with a reason for each, and one suggestion the author could act on. The stars identify what to keep. The wish identifies a change to consider. It can be a direct, respectful question: "Could you name the unit on the vertical axis?" or "What does Figure 3 add that Figure 2 does not show?"

**TASK 1 — Your preferences (15 minutes)**

Please form groups of three or four. A group of five is fine if the numbers do not divide evenly. Take turns discussing these questions, and write your own responses in Part 1 of the sheet:

1. When has feedback helped you improve something? What made it useful? An example from school, work, a sport or a hobby is fine.
2. When has feedback been difficult to use? Was information missing, or was there something about its timing or delivery?
3. What would you like this group to know about how you prefer to receive feedback?

Please share only examples you are comfortable discussing. A general description is enough; you do not need to name the people involved.

When someone is showing their draft, please listen and take notes before offering comments. When receiving feedback, let the speaker finish, then ask about anything you do not understand. The author decides which changes to make and can explain that decision in Part 3.

# Part 2: Reviewing the drafts

Please review what is in the draft now. The Report 1 brief and rubric give the requirements; use them to identify a useful next step. A missing section can be recorded as a section to draft. You do not need to predict its eventual quality or assign points.

*What to look for*

Start with the research question and the three figures. For each figure, ask what it contributes that the other two cannot show. Then read the interpretation and the Discussion to see whether the written answer follows from those figures.

- **Data and question.** Can you tell what one row represents and where the data came from? Does the dataset card answer the nine fields from Lab 2, Part 2? Does the question name the variables, units and comparison, with background explaining why it matters (Lab 2, Part 3)?
- **Variables and wrangling.** Are the variables' meanings, types and units stated? Can you follow the changes to the data, including what happened to missing values?
- **Each figure.** Can you read the axes, units and legend? Does its caption say what is plotted, what one mark is, and the main pattern? Is the comparison clear on the scales shown?
- **The three together.** Does each add something to the answer? At least one must be faceted with `facet\_wrap()` or `facet\_grid()`. Three versions of the same comparison do not meet the brief's requirement (Lab 3, Part 3).
- **Interpretations.** Does each figure have its own paragraph, naming its number, a comparison with numbers in their units, what it means for the question, and what it cannot establish (Lab 4, Part 1)? The numbers in that paragraph come from inline R.
- **Discussion.** Does the summary answer the question using all three figures? Are the implications supported, the limitations specific to these data, and the next analysis clear enough to carry out (Lab 4, Part 2)?
- **Code and files.** Is the code visible and readable, with only useful output printed? Does the report have its generative AI disclosure? If a number or a data-cleaning step is unclear, ask the author to show you the code that produced it.

Report 1 asks for summaries and differences from the data. Statistical tests and p values are not required. The optional website is separate extra credit; please review the report first.

*Each person's turn*

Three people have 20 minutes each, four have 15, and five have 12. The timings below are for a group of four; shorten or extend each step to fit your group. Keep a record in Part 2 of the sheet as you go, and say your feedback aloud so the author hears it.

**TASK 2 — Review a draft (15 minutes)**

**First, show the draft (4 minutes).** The author introduces the dataset and research question, shows the figures, and explains what each contributes to the answer. Please include an interpretation and the Discussion if drafted, and name one concern you would like help with. Everyone else listens and takes notes.

**Second, share the stars (3 minutes).** Each reviewer identifies two things that work and records why. Share these with the group; comments can build on one another if they refer to the same feature.

**Third, discuss the wishes (5 minutes).** Each reviewer records one suggestion. As a group, discuss the one or two changes you think would most improve the report. Please name the figure or section, explain what was unclear, and suggest a next step. The author can ask questions and records the feedback received.

**Fourth, consider an alternative (3 minutes).** Choose one figure and suggest another way to answer its question: a different type of plot, grouping, variable, or arrangement of panels. What would that version make easier to see, and what might it make harder? Then move to the next author.

**NOTE — If the draft is incomplete**

A dataset card, a question, or an exploratory figure can each be reviewed. Say what the current work makes clear and suggest the next figure or paragraph to try. Please describe a missing section as missing, so the author can distinguish feedback on the draft from an idea for work they have not done yet.

# Part 3: Reflection and revision

Please take fifteen minutes to write your own reflection and plan, then five minutes to discuss what you noticed about giving feedback. Your plan can include a suggestion you decide against, with a reason. For example, combining two figures may make a comparison easier but leave you needing a different third figure to answer the full question.

**TASK 3 — Your revision plan**

Part 3 of the sheet asks for four things:

1. The one or two comments that most changed how you see your draft, and why.
2. Two or three specific changes, in the order you intend to make them. For each, name the figure or section and say how you will check that the revision helped. If you decide against a suggestion, explain why.
3. Something you learned from reading another person's work that you can apply to your own report.
4. What you noticed about the feedback itself. Did giving a comment reveal a similar problem in your report? Did the way someone phrased a comment help? Did knowing their preferences change how you gave feedback?

Please use the next ten minutes to start the first revision in your report. In the sheet, record what you changed, how you checked it, and what remains to do. If you cannot finish the change today, record the first step and what you still need.

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SUBMISSION

- ☐ Knit your document to PDF
- ☐ Check that all code is visible (not running off the page)
- ☐ Check that all output displays correctly
- ☐ Submit both `.Rmd` and `.pdf` files